



BHUTAN

DETAILS**ITINERARY**

Day 1 : Arrival at Delhi. Overnight in Delhi
Day 2 : Delhi to Bhutan by flight. Arrival – Paro Sightseeing & Drive to Thimphu
Day 3 : Thimphu Exploration
Day 4 : Thimphu-Punakha
Day 5 : Punakha –Phobjikha
Day 6 : Phobjikha- Bumthang
Day 7 : Bumthang Exploration
Day 8 : Bumthang (Excursion to Tang Valley)
Day 9 : Fly to Paro - Hike to Taktsang
Day 10 : Paro- Delhi
Day 11 : Delhi
Day 12 : Delhi
Day 13 : Delhi- Agra
Day 14 : Agra
Day 15 : Departure from Delhi

Bhutan, the mystical Land of the Thunder Dragon, offers travellers a unique blend of breathtaking natural beauty, rich cultural heritage, and profound spirituality. From the soaring peaks of the Himalayas to serene valleys dotted with ancient monasteries, this enchanting kingdom invites you to step into a world where tradition and modernity coexist in harmony. Every journey through Bhutan reveals its timeless charm, from vibrant festivals and sacred temples to the warm hospitality of its people, making it an unforgettable destination for explorers seeking both adventure and cultural immersion.

This carefully crafted itinerary takes you on a seamless journey across Bhutan's most iconic regions. Beginning in the scenic Paro Valley, you will explore historic Dzongs (fortresses), sacred temples, and the country's charming capital, Thimphu. The journey continues through Punakha and Phobjikha, offering serene landscapes, wildlife encounters, and spiritual insights, before reaching the culturally rich Bumthang region. The itinerary culminates with a memorable hike to the legendary Taktsang Monastery, perched dramatically on a cliffside, leaving travellers with lasting memories of Bhutan's mystical beauty and serene spirit.

Returning from the serene landscapes of Bhutan, your journey continues in New Delhi, where grand boulevards, Mughal-era architecture, and vibrant bazaars offer a compelling introduction to India's rich cultural heritage. Explore landmarks such as Qutab Minar, Lotus Temple and experience the contrast of Old Delhi's bustling lanes with the elegance of Lutyens' capital. A short drive brings you to Agra, home to the iconic Taj Mahal, a timeless symbol of love best experienced at sunrise. Complemented by visits to the majestic Agra Fort and curated heritage experiences, this extension offers a perfect finale blending history, romance, and architectural grandeur

DETAILED ITINERARY**Day 1: Arrive at Delhi International airport.**

On arrival, you will be transferred to the hotel. Rest of the day at leisure.

Day 2: Arrival – Paro Sightseeing & Drive to Thimphu

Arrive at Paro Airport, renowned as one of the most scenic airports in the world, surrounded by towering Himalayan peaks. After completing immigration and visa formalities, you will be warmly greeted by your experienced Bhutanese guide.

Begin your exploration of Paro with a visit to Ta Dzong, the National Museum of Bhutan, where a remarkable collection of ancient artifacts, thangkas, and religious relics offer insight into Bhutan's rich cultural and historical heritage. Continue to Rinpung Dzong, an impressive fortress-monastery that exemplifies Bhutanese architecture, serving both as an administrative centre and a spiritual hub.

Following your sightseeing, embark on a picturesque drive to Thimphu, Bhutan's vibrant capital nestled in a broad, scenic valley. En route, visit Tachogang Lhakhang, a 15th-century temple established by the legendary engineer and saint Thangtong Gyalpo, renowned for constructing iron chain suspension bridges across Bhutan. Enjoy a short walk across the traditional iron chain suspension bridge spanning the Paro River, offering a unique introduction to Bhutan's blend of spirituality, engineering ingenuity, and natural beauty.

Drive Distance: 50km, 1.5 hours

Meals: Lunch & Dinner

Day 3: Thimphu Exploration



Begin your day exploring Thimphu, the vibrant capital of Bhutan, where tradition and modernity exist in perfect harmony. Start at the National Memorial Chorten, an iconic white stupa crowned with a golden spire, built in memory of the Third King, Jigme Dorji Wangchuck. Dedicated to world peace, this spiritual landmark is a place where locals gather to circumambulate in prayer, surrounded by exquisite Buddhist architecture, intricate paintings, and sculptures symbolizing the “Mind of Buddha.”

Continue to Buddha Point, home to the towering Buddha Dordenma Statue, one of the largest in the world, gazing peacefully over the Thimphu valley as a symbol of happiness and serenity.

Next, visit Changangkha Lhakhang, a 12th-century fortress-like temple perched on a ridge, revered for blessings, especially for newborns, and offering sweeping views of the city. Enjoy a traditional Bhutanese lunch at a local restaurant before heading to the National Institute for Zorig Chusum, also known as the school of 13 Traditional Arts and Crafts. Established in 1971, this unique institute is dedicated to preserving Bhutan’s traditional arts such as painting, sculpting, wood carving, paper making, masonry, weaving, embroidery, and more.

Following this, visit the Textile Museum, where you will discover Bhutan’s vibrant textile traditions, renowned for their intricate patterns and vibrant colors. The museum exhibits traditional weaving techniques and showcases garments that highlight Bhutanese identity and craftsmanship, offering an exceptional appreciation of this living art form. End your day at the magnificent Tashichho Dzong, a grand fortress and monastery that serves as the seat of Bhutan’s government and the summer residence of the Chief Abbot. With its whitewashed walls, gilded roofs, and intricate woodwork, the dzong stands as a masterpiece of Bhutanese architecture and a venue for the vibrant Thimphu Tshechu festival. This full-day journey weaves

together spirituality, culture, wildlife, and history, offering a truly immersive introduction to Bhutan's capital.

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch & Dinner

Day 4 : Thimphu-Punakha



This day, we will visit Simtokha Dzong, the oldest fortress in Bhutan, built in 1629. Renowned for its historical significance and stunning murals, this Dzong is a remarkable example of Bhutanese architectural heritage and spiritual tradition.

From Thimphu, we will drive toward Punakha, stopping en route at Dochula Pass, located about 30 kilometers from the capital. This mountain pass offers breathtaking 360-degree panoramic views of the Himalayan Mountain range. The site is adorned with 108 chortens, memorial stupas built by the Queen Mother to honor Bhutanese soldiers who lost their lives during the 2003 conflict with Indian rebels.

Dochula Pass is also a popular spiritual place for locals and tourists alike, with an important temple situated at the crest of the pass, adding to its serene atmosphere. Afterward, enjoy lunch in Lobesa, then make your way to Sopsokha, a village along the highway between Punakha and Wangdue Phodrang, about 10 to 11 kilometers from Punakha town. Sopsokha is easily accessible by taxi, private car, or local bus.

From Sopsokha, you can reach Chimi Lhakhang, the famous “Fertility Temple,” with a gentle and scenic walk. The trail is about 1.5 kilometers one way and typically takes 20 to 30 minutes at a moderate pace. The path leads through lush paddy fields, gentle slopes, and traditional houses of Sopsokha village, many decorated with phallic symbols—an homage to the temple's unique history. The walk is mostly flat, with only a mild ascent near the end as you approach the small hill where the temple sits.

Founded by the colourful saint Drukpa Kunley, Chimi Lhakhang exudes a light-hearted yet sacred atmosphere. Its whimsical artwork and phallic symbols reflect Bhutanese humour and spirituality, making it a truly unique cultural landmark. Overnight in Punakha

Walking: 30-40 minutes

Distance: 70km, 2-3 hours

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch & Dinner

Day 5 : Punakha -Phobjikha



In the morning, begin your day with a visit to the magnificent Punakha Dzong, one of Bhutan's most iconic fortress-monasteries, known for its stunning riverside location, intricate woodwork, and historical significance as the former capital of Bhutan. After exploring the dzong, take a scenic drive from Punakha to Phobjikha Valley, passing through beautiful, forested valleys and mountainous terrain. The valley near Gangtey is renowned for its serene environment and is the winter home of the rare, black-necked cranes.

This journey leads you across beautiful landscapes of Bhutan, including forested valleys and mountainous terrain, gradually approaching the Phobjikha Valley. Known for its serene environment, the valley is famous as a winter home to the rare, black-necked cranes.

Exploration in the Phobjikha region begins with a visit to the historic and architecturally elegant Gangtey Goempa (Monastery). This is one of the biggest Nyingma monasteries in the entire country and is an architectural marvel. This visit also allows you to appreciate the monastery's spiritual significance and beautiful surroundings.

Next, proceed to the Black Necked Crane Information Centre nearby. The centre provides valuable insights into the conservation of these endangered birds and offers mounted binoculars for observing the cranes in their natural marshland habitat, especially during their

winter months from late October to mid-February. This day offers a harmonious blend of nature, culture, and wildlife.

Drive Distance: 78km, 3 hours

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch & Dinner

Day 6 : Phobjikha- Bumthang

Today, we take a scenic drive towards Bumthang, one of the most beautiful and culturally rich regions in Bhutan. The journey is filled with stunning landscapes and historical sights. Our first stop along the way is the Chendebji Chorten, a prominent stupa built in the 18th century, located near the village of Chendebji. This serene spot is a perfect place to stretch your legs while taking in the peaceful surroundings.

Continuing our drive, we'll pass through the picturesque village of Trongsa and its impressive Trongsa Dzong, perched dramatically on a ridge above the town. A visit to the Royal Heritage Museum in Trongsa provides fascinating insights into Bhutan's royal history, offering an educational break during our drive.

Lunch will be served at the tranquil Willing Falls, a delightful spot perfect for a relaxing break amidst the journey. After lunch, we continue our drive towards Bumthang, arriving in the evening. We arrive at our hotel in Bumthang, where you can unwind and prepare for another day of exploring the region.

Optional Hot Stone Bath: *You can experience a traditional Hot Stone Bath with advance notice. Hot stone bath is purely a Bhutanese traditional method of curing skin ailments, joint pains, hypertension, stomach disorders, arthritis, and many other minor diseases. Even if you don't have any of these issues, after a laborious hike of the day, you will feel relaxation from the hot stone bath. Pre-booking is a requirement.*

Distance: 154km. 5-6 hours

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch & Dinner

Day 7: Bumthang Exploration

After a hearty breakfast, we begin our day in Bumthang with a walking tour to visit three of the region's most revered temples: Jambay Lhakhang, Kurjey Lhakhang, and Tamshing Lhakhang. These temples are rich in history and spirituality, offering insight into Bhutanese Buddhist traditions. Jambay Lhakhang, built in the 7th century by the Tibetan King Songtsen Gampo, is an iconic pilgrimage site. Kurjey Lhakhang, with its beautiful architecture, houses the rock imprint of Guru Rinpoche, who meditated here. Tamshing Lhakhang, founded by the famous Lama Pema Lingpa, is an important centre for spiritual learning and known for its sacred murals. The walk between these temples takes you through beautiful landscapes, offering a chance to enjoy the peaceful surroundings of Bumthang.



In the afternoon, we'll visit the Dorjibi Weaving Centre, where you can witness the intricate art of traditional Bhutanese weaving. The centre is famous for producing beautiful textiles, including handwoven fabrics and garments, showcasing the skilled craftsmanship of the locals. It's an excellent opportunity to learn about the significance of weaving in Bhutanese culture and purchase some unique souvenirs. Overnight in Bumthang.

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch & Dinner

Day 8 : Bumthang (Excursion to Tang Valley)

After an early breakfast, we embark on an exciting excursion to the scenic Tang Valley, one of the most beautiful valleys in Bhutan. As we drive through the valley, the stunning landscapes unfold around us, offering views of terraced fields, traditional farmhouses, and the surrounding mountains.

Our first stop is the Burning Lake (also known as Me Bar Tsho), one of the most sacred sites in Bhutan. It is said that in the 14th century, Guru Rinpoche's disciple, Pema Lingpa, discovered a hidden treasure in the lake, and the site has since become a pilgrimage spot for Bhutanese Buddhists. The lake's serene beauty, combined with its spiritual significance, creates a profoundly peaceful atmosphere.

Next, we visit the Pema Choling Nunnery, an important center for nuns in the region. This peaceful nunnery provides insight into the monastic life and the role of women in Bhutanese spirituality. Here, you can interact with the nuns and learn about their daily routines, meditation practices, and the teachings they follow.

Afterward, we explore the Ogyen Cholling Palace Museum, which was once the ancestral home of the Chhoetje family, a prominent family in the region. The museum offers a fascinating

glimpse into the history of the family and the cultural heritage of the Tang Valley. The exhibits include traditional artifacts, clothing, and items used in the past, reflecting Bhutan's rich cultural traditions.

Afterward, we'll have some time to relax and explore the surroundings before returning to Bumthang for the night.

Total Distance: 90km, 3-4 hours
Meals: Breakfast, Lunch & Dinner

Accommodation: Rincholing /similar

Day 9: Fly to Paro - Hike to Taktsang



After breakfast, take a short domestic flight back to Paro, offering breathtaking aerial views of the Himalayan peaks and the Paro Valley. Upon arrival, prepare for one of Bhutan's most iconic experiences: the hike to Taktsang Monastery (Tiger's Nest), perched dramatically on a cliffside at 3,120 meters (10,240 ft).

The hike begins with a gentle uphill walk-through lush pine forests, prayer flags fluttering in the breeze, and small streams that enrich the serene landscape. Halfway up, pause at the Cafeteria Viewpoint, where you can enjoy refreshments while taking in stunning panoramic views of the monastery clinging to the cliff face. Continue ascending along winding trails adorned with sacred mani stones and small shrines, immersing yourself in Bhutan's spiritual heritage.

Arrive at Taktsang Monastery, a 17th-century sacred site where Guru Rinpoche is said to have meditated after flying to this cliff on the back of a tigress. Explore the monastery's chapels and courtyards, witnessing intricate murals, prayer halls, and the devotion of pilgrims. After soaking

in the spiritual atmosphere, begin the descent to the base, taking time to capture photographs of the monastery framed against the dramatic valley below.

Return to your hotel in Paro for check-in and enjoy the evening at leisure, reflecting on the awe inspiring experience of Bhutan's most revered pilgrimage site.

Hike Duration: 4-5 hours

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch & Dinner

Accommodation: Naksel Boutique/ similar

Day 10: Paro- Delhi | Departure

After breakfast at your hotel, enjoy some leisure time for last-minute shopping or a short stroll in Paro town, picking up souvenirs or local handicrafts. Depending on your flight schedule, your guide will assist with transfers to Paro Airport.

Check in for your onward flight, taking with you unforgettable memories of Bhutan's spectacular landscapes, rich culture, and warm hospitality.

Arrive at Delhi International airport and transfer to the hotel

Meals: Breakfast & Dinner

Day 11: Delhi - Old & New Delhi – Culture, Heritage & Curated Experiences

Begin your day with a visit to Humayun's Tomb, a masterpiece of Mughal architecture set within beautifully landscaped gardens, offering a tranquil start to your exploration. Continue to Qutub Minar, where intricate carvings and towering stonework reflect Delhi's layered history. A stop at the serene Lotus Temple provides a moment of quiet reflection amidst its striking modern design.

In the afternoon, experience the vibrant energy of Old Delhi with a curated walk or rickshaw ride through Chandni Chowk, offering an authentic glimpse into local life, traditional markets, and culinary heritage. The day concludes at Connaught Place, where you can explore boutique stores, enjoy a curated shopping experience, or dine at one of the capital's finest restaurants.

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch & Dinner

Day 12: Spiritual & Contemporary Delhi – Culture at Leisure

Start your day with a visit to Swaminarayan Akshardham, an architectural marvel known for its intricate craftsmanship and immersive cultural exhibitions that offer insight into India's spiritual traditions. The experience is both visually grand and deeply engaging, making it a highlight of modern Delhi.

The remainder of the day is designed around your personal interests, opt for a private art and gallery tour, a curated culinary experience exploring regional Indian cuisines, or a bespoke shopping journey featuring fine textiles, jewellery, and design. Alternatively, enjoy a leisurely afternoon at your hotel with spa therapies or wellness treatments, ensuring a balanced and unhurried exploration of the city.

Day 13: Delhi to Agra – Journey into Mughal Grandeur

Depart Delhi and drive along the Yamuna Expressway to Agra, ensuring a smooth and comfortable journey. Upon arrival, check into your hotel, where the afternoon is at leisure to relax and soak in the setting.

In the evening, visit Mehtab Bagh for a serene and less-crowded view of the Taj Mahal at sunset, as the monument changes hues in the fading light. Return to your hotel for an exclusive dining experience, with the option of a private setup that enhances the sense of occasion.

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch & Dinner

Day 14: Taj Mahal Sunrise & Agra Fort – Timeless Icons

Begin early with a sunrise visit to the Taj Mahal, when the soft morning light reveals its finest details and the atmosphere is at its most tranquil. Accompanied by an expert guide, gain deeper insight into the history, symbolism, and craftsmanship behind this iconic monument.

Return to your hotel for a leisurely breakfast before heading to Agra Fort, a magnificent red sandstone fortress that once served as the seat of Mughal power. The afternoon is at leisure, choose to indulge in a spa treatment, enjoy a curated storytelling session on Mughal history, or simply relax in the comfort of your hotel with views of the Taj.



Meals: Breakfast, Lunch & Dinner

Day 15: Departure transfer

After a relaxed morning, depart Agra and drive back to Delhi in time for your onward international flight. A seamless transfer ensures a comfortable conclusion to your journey, bringing together the spiritual calm of Bhutan with the rich history and cultural depth of India.

ACCOMMODATION

Thimphu- Le Meridien



Punakha - Uma Punakha



Gangtey- Gangtey Goenpa



Bumthang- Six senses



Paro – COMO Uma Paro



Delhi – Trident Gurgaon



Agra- Oberoi Amarvilas

Inclusions

- Accommodation in Thimphu for 2 nights
- Accommodation in Punakha for 1 night
- Accommodation in Gangtey for 1 night
- Accommodation in Bumthang for 3 nights
- Accommodation in Paro for 1 night
- Accommodation in Delhi for 3 nights
- Accommodation in Agra for 2 nights
- Airport transfers in Delhi and Thimphu
- All transfers and sightseeing as on itinerary.
- Meals as per the itinerary
- English speaking local Tour Guide
- Sightseeing admission fee
- Domestic Flight (Bumthang to Paro)
- Delhi- Paro- Delhi flight ticket
- All applicable taxes as on date

Exclusions

- International air ticket other than the mentioned
- Expenses of personal nature such as drinks, tip, laundry, phone etc.
- Extra expenses due to nature and unforeseen events.
- Travel Insurance.
- Visa

Notes

- Rooms are subject to availability at the time of booking
